

0.0.1 Natural Course

dharmatā

19. Then, O bhikkhus, the bodhisatta Vipassī, having passed away from the Tusita group, mindful and contemplative, descended into his mother's womb. This here, is the natural course.

atha kho bhikkhave, vipassī bodhisatto tusitā kāyā cavitvā sato sampajāno mātukucchiṃ okkami. aya-mettha dhammatā.

20. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta, having passed away from the Tusita group, descends into his mother's womb, then in the world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, an immeasurable vast radiance becomes manifest, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas. Even those spaces inbetween worlds that are void, in utter darkness, pitch black darkness, where even the radiance of these moon and sun, of such power, of such mighty splendor, cannot reach, even there, an immeasurable vast radiance becomes manifest, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas. Even those beings that have arisen there perceive one another by that radiance [thinking]: "Apparently sir, there are also other beings that have arisen here." And this ten thousand world system shakes, quakes and trembles. That an im-

measurable and vast radiance becomes manifest in the world, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas, this here is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto tusitā kāyā cavitvā mātukucchiṃ okkamati, atha sadevake loke samārake sabrahmake, sassamaṇabrāhmaṇiyā pajāya sadevamanussāya appamāṇo uḷāro² obhāso pātubhavati atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. yā pi tā lokantarikā aghā asaṃvutā andhakārā andhakāratimisā, yatthapime candimasuriyā evaṃmahiddhikā evaṃmahānubhāvā ābhāya nānubhonti, tatthapi appamāṇo uḷāro obhāso pātubhavati atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvā. yepi tattha sattā uppannā,¹ te pi tenobhāsena aññaṃaññaṃ sañjānanti ‘aññepi kira bho santi sattā idhūpapannā’ti. ayañca dasasahassī lokadhātu saṃkampati sampakampati sampavedhati. appamāṇo ca uḷāro obhāso loke pātubhavati atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. ayamettha dhammatā.

21. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta descends into his mother’s womb, four sons of devas undertake the guarding of the four directions [thinking]: “Let not the bodhisatta or the bodhisatta’s mother be troubled by any Human or non-human or anything.” This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchiṃ okkanto hoti, cattāro naṃ devaputtā catuddisaṃ² rakkhāya upagacchanti: ‘mā naṃ bodhisattaṃ vā bodhisattamātaraṃ vā manusso vā amanusso vā koci vā viheṭhesī’ti. ayamettha dhammatā.

22. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta descends into his mother’s womb, the bodhisatta’s mother becomes naturally virtuous, abstaining from killing living beings, abstaining from taking what is not given, abstaining from misconduct in sensual pleasures, abstaining from false speech, abstaining from drinking distilled and fermented liquor that are the bases for negligence. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchiṃ okkanto hoti, pakatīyā sīlavatī bodhisattamātā hoti viratā paṇātipātā, viratā adinnādānā, viratā kāmesu micchācārā, viratā musāvādā, viratā surāmerayamajjapamādaṭṭhānā. ayamettha dhammatā.

23. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta descends into his mother’s womb, the bodhisatta’s mother’s mind does not arise concerning the cords of sensual pleasures in men. The bodhisatta’s mother becomes one not to be transgressed against by any man with a lustful mind. This here, is the natural

course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchiṃ okkanto hoti, na bodhisattamātu purisese mānasam uppajjati kāmaguṇūpasamhitam. anatikkamaniyā ca bodhisattamātā hoti kenaci purisena rattacittena. ayamettha dhammatā.

24. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta descends into his mother's womb, the bodhisatta's mother becomes a gainer of the five cords of sensual pleasures. She indeed amuses herself being furnished and endowed with the five cords of sensual pleasures. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchiṃ okkanto hoti, lābhinī bodhisattamātā hoti pañcannaṃ kāmaguṇānaṃ. sā pañcahi kāmaguṇehi samappitā samaṅgībhūtā paricāreti. ayamettha dhammatā.

25. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta descends into his mother's womb, there isn't any affliction that arises in the bodhisatta's mother. The bodhisatta's mother comes to be at ease, without any bodily tiredness. And the bodhisatta's mother sees the bodhisatta within her womb, complete with all his limbs, not deficient in any sense faculty. Suppose, O bhikkhus, that there were a beautiful beryl gem, flawless, with eight

facets, of excellent workmanship, finely crafted, transparent, bright, placid, perfect in every way, strung therein with either a blue or yellow or red or white or brown thread. Of them a man with good eyes having held it in his hands would review thus: “This beautiful beryl gem, flawless, with eight facets, of excellent workmanship, finely crafted, transparent, bright, placid, perfect in every way, is strung therein with either a blue or yellow or red or white or brown thread.” So too, O bhikkhus, when the bodhisatta descends into his mother’s womb, there isn’t any affliction that arises in the bodhisatta’s mother. The bodhisatta’s mother comes to be at ease, without any bodily tiredness. And the bodhisatta’s mother sees the bodhisatta within her womb, complete with all his limbs, not deficient in any sense faculty. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchiṃ okkanto hoti, na bodhisattamātu koccideva ābādho uppajjati. sukhinī bodhisattamātā hoti akilantakāyā. bodhisattañca bodhisattamātā tirokucchigataṃ passati sabbaṅgapaccamaṃ ahīnindriyaṃ. seyyathāpi bhikkhave, maṇi velūriyo subho jātimā aṭṭhaṃso suparikammakato accho vipasanno anāvilo sabbākārasampanno, tatra yaṃ suttaṃ āvutaṃ nīlaṃ vā pītaṃ vā lohitaṃ vā odātaṃ vā paṇḍusuttaṃ vā, tamenam cakkhumā puriso hatthe karitvā paccavekkheyya: ayaṃ kho maṇi velūriyo subho jātimā aṭṭhaṃso suparikammakato accho vipasanno sabbākāra sampanno,

tatridaṃ suttaṃ āvutaṃ nīlaṃ vā pītaṃ vā lohitaṃ vā odātaṃ vā paṇḍusuttaṃ vā'ti. evameva kho bhikkhave yadā bodhisatto mātukucchiṃ okkanto hoti, na bodhisattamātu kocideva ābādhō uppajjati, sukhinī bodhisattamātā hoti akilanta-kāyā. bodhisattañca bodhisattamātā tirokucchi-gataṃ passati sabbaṅgapaccaṅgiṃ ahīnindriyaṃ. ayamettha dhammatā:

26. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta is seven days old, the bodhisatta's mother passes away and arises in the Tusita group. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, sattāhajāte bodhisatte bodhisattamātā kālaṃ karoti, tusitaṃ, kāyaṃ upapajjati. ayamettha dhammatā.

27. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that while other women, having carried about the embryo in their stomach for nine or ten months, they give birth, it is indeed not so for the bodhisatta's mother giving birth to the bodhisatta. The bodhisatta's mother, having carried about the bodhisatta in her stomach for exactly ten months, she gives birth to the bodhisatta. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yathā aññā itthikā nava vā dasa vā māse gabbhaṃ kucchinā pariharitvā

vijāyanti, na hevaṃ bodhisattam bodhisattamātā vijāyati. daseva māsāni bodhisattam bodhisattamātā kucchinā pariharitvā vijāyati. ayamettha dhammatā.

28. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that while other women, having sat down or laid down, they give birth, it is indeed not so for the bodhisatta's mother giving birth to the bodhisatta. The bodhisatta's mother, having just stood up, she gives birth to the bodhisatta. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yathā aññā itthikā nisinnā vā nipannā vā vijāyanti, na hevaṃ bodhisattam bodhisattamātā vijāyati. t̥hitā'va bodhisattam bodhisattamātā vijāyati. ayamettha dhammatā.

29. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when bodhisatta comes out of his mother's womb, first, devas receive him, afterwards humans. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchimhā nikkhamati, devā paṭhamam patigaṇhanti, pacchā manussā. ayamettha dhammatā.

30. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, when the bodhisatta comes out of his mother's womb, the bod-

hisatta does not even touch the earth. The four sons of devas, having received him, place him in front of his mother, saying: “Be happy, O queen! A son of great influence has arisen for you.” This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchimhā nikkhamati, appatto’va bodhisatto paṭhaviṃ hoti. cattāro naṃ devaputtā paṭiggahetvā mātu purato ṭhapenti. ‘attamanā devi hohi mahesakkho. te putto uppanno’ti. ayamettha dhammatā.

31. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta comes out of his mother’s womb, he certainly comes out clean, unsmeared by amniotic fluids, unsmeared by phlegm, unsmeared by blood, unsmeared by any impurities, purified and clean. Just as, O bhikkhus, a precious gem were to be put down on a Kasi cloth. The precious gem will neither smear the Kasi cloth, nor would the Kasi cloth smear the precious gem. What is the reason for that? Purity of both. So too, O bhikkhus, when the bodhisatta comes out of his mother’s womb, he certainly comes out clean, unsmeared by amniotic fluids, unsmeared by phlegm, unsmeared by blood, unsmeared by any impurities, purified and clean. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mā-

tukucchimhā nikkhamati, visado'va nikkhamati amakkhito uddena¹, amakkhito semhena, amakkhito ruhirena, amakkhito kenaci asucinā, suddho visado. seyyathāpi bhikkhave, maṇiratanam kāsike vatthe nikkhattam neva maṇiratanam kāsikaṃ vattham makkheti, nāpi kāsikaṃ vattham maṇiratanam makkheti - tam kissa hetu: ubhinnaṃ suddhattā. evameva kho bhikkhave yadā bodhisatto mātukucchimhā nikkhamati, visado'va nikkhamati amakkhito uddena, amakkhito semhena, amakkhito ruhirena, amakkhito kenaci asucinā, suddho visado. ayamettha dhammatā.

32. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta comes out of his mother's womb, two streams of water become manifest in the sky, one cool, one warm, with which the bodhisatta and his mother bathe. This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchimhā nikkhamati, dve udakassa dhārā² antalikkhā pātubhavanti: ekā sītassa ekā uṇhassa, yena bodhisattassa udakakiccaṃ karonti mātucca³. ayamettha dhammatā.

33. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that after the birth of the bodhisatta, having placed his feet evenly on the ground, facing north, with a white parasol held over him, he takes seven steps, surveys all directions,

and speaks these words: “I am the foremost of the world, I am the best of the world, I am the most excellent of the world, this is my last birth, now there is no more future being.” This here, is the natural course.

dhammatā esā bhikkhave, sampatijāto bodhisatto samehi pādehi patiṭṭhahitvā uttarābhimukho¹ satta padavīti²hāre³ gacchati setamhi chatte anuhīramāne³, sabbā ca disā anuviloketi⁴, āsabhiñca vācambhāsatī: “aggo’hamasmi lokassa, jeṭṭho’hamasmi lokassa, seṭṭho’hamasmi lokassa, ayaman-timā jāti, natthi’dāni punabbhavo”ti. ayamettha dhammatā.

34. This is the natural course, O bhikkhus, that when the bodhisatta comes out of his mother’s womb, then in the world with its devas, maras and brahmas, together with the population of samanas and brahmanas, devas and humans, an immeasurable vast radiance becomes manifest, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas. Even those spaces inbetween worlds that are void, in utter darkness, pitch black darkness, where even the radiance of these moon and sun, of such power, of such mighty splendor, cannot reach, even there, an immeasurable vast radiance becomes manifest, really surpassing the heavenly splendor of the devas. Even those beings that have arisen there perceive one another by that radiance [thinking]: “Apparently sir, there are also other beings that have arisen here.” And this ten thousand

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dhammatā esā bhikkhave, yadā bodhisatto mātukucchimhā nikkhamati, atha sadevake loke samārake sabrahmake, sassamaṇabrāhmaṇiyā pajāya sadevamanussāya appamāṇo ulāro obhāso pātubhavati, atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. yā’pi tā lokantarikā aghā asaṃvutā andhakārā andhakāratimisā, yatthapime candimasuriyā evammahānubhāvā ābhāya nānubhonti, tatthapi appamāṇo ulāro obhāso pātu bhavati atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. ye’pi tattha sattā uppannā, te’pi tenobhāsenā aññamaññaṃ sañjānanti: “aññe’pi kira bho santi sattā idhūpapannā”ti. ayañca dasasahassī lokadhātu saṃkampati sampakampati sampavedhati. appamāṇo ca ulāro obhāso loke pātubhavati atikkammeva devānaṃ devānubhāvaṃ. ayamettha dhammatā.

